



With Strings Attached

Music forms a big part of Uppal's life. He is a great devotee of classic bands such as The Eagles and Dire Straits.

REUBEN SINGH

"I BELIEVE IN THE PROCESS RATHER
than the result. Instead of worrying, I concentrate on giving my hundred per cent."

VISHAAL UPPAL, SPORTS BOULEVARD, 32

Forty-two international tennis titles and Indian Davis Cupper between 1999 and 2007. Tennis was Vishaal Uppal's life, until a dust allergy forced him to quit the courts last year. With his undying passion for sports, he laid the foundation of Sports Boulevard, a sports management company in February 2008. "It was an obvious choice," says Uppal, whose goal was to promote sports, especially tennis, in the country. For the commerce graduate from the Shri Ram College of Commerce in Delhi, starting a business of his own was not a very difficult task. His tennis background helped, allowing him, for instance, to snap up the rising star Somdev Devvarman, for whom they are handling everything, from his publicity to sponsorships. Oddly though, Uppal's first love was cricket and he found himself playing tennis only by accident during a school break with his friends at Modern School, Delhi. Uppal now plans to focus on quality work instead of quantity. "I don't want to bite more than I can chew," he says. He is looking at organising tennis events, but the current slowdown has acted as a spoilsport with many sponsors backing out of events that were being planned by the company. But Uppal hasn't lost hope. After all, patience is a game whose rules he is familiar with.

by Nikita Jain

**"GREAT COMPANIES
THINK OF NEW
ideas to steer through
rough business
environments."**

RAKESH ANTALA,
CREDERITY INFO SERVICES, 32

SANJAY RAMCHANDRAN



It is a tall order but he is in the business of empowering integrity. As the web's first guaranteed trust builder, Rakesh Antala's Credernity Info Services provides identity authentication services for individuals in India and the US. Given the lack of a functioning ID system in India, and increasingly serious reports of fraud, the country is perfect ground for credential authentication. "We build online tools to help establish trust in a world where the good and the real good are not necessarily the same," says Antala. Set up first in the US in 2005 and then launched in India in 2007, the company applies sophisticated technologies to help people and businesses in resume validation, matrimonials, tutorials and net

banking. For this, Credernity gives each verified user a Credernity Trust Seal, which can be associated with the users' online profiles, blogs, and other online presences. "We realise we're going up against big odds, but that's what makes it a satisfying problem to counter," explains Antala. Credernity has helped thousands of individuals prove their identity and integrity through its partnerships with websites such as SimplyMarry, tutor-source and FirstNaukri among several others. With Credernity India taking off, he is currently gearing up for the global launch by end-2009. That is bound to

be a successful journey for the chemical engineer from Gujarat. And as Credernity's tag line says, Trust Matters. **by Amarnath K. Menon**

Role Model

Richard Branson of Virgin Group because he is an entrepreneur at heart and an adventurer who appreciates life.